

LAURA SOFIA RIVERA SANCHEZ

 University of Toronto

✉ laura.rivera.sanchez@mail.utoronto.ca

EDUCATION

University of Toronto

PhD: political science

(Expected 2028)

MA: political science

Sept. 2022 - June 2023

Concordia University

BA: Honours political science

Sept. 2020 - April 2022

McGill University

BSc: Honours mathematics and Minor in physics

Sept. 2016 - April 2020

CONFERENCES

American Political Science Association (APSA)

Sept. 2026

“In the Absence of Migrants:

Affective traces in transit rural communities” – *Panelist*

International Migration Research Network (IMISCOE)

July 2026

“Conceptualising Transit Communities: An affective milieu of
absence ↔ presence, foreigners ↔ locals,
illegality ↔ legality & periphery ↔ centre” – *Panelist*

Harney Program Symposium - Barriers & Borders:

March 2026

“When Irregularised Migration Moves– and When It Doesn’t: :

Reflecting on Methods for Tracing Affect in Transit Communities ” – *Panelist*

Prairie Political Science Association (PPSA)

Sept. 2025

“From Unemployment to Housing Affordability:

Immigration & the economy in Canadian immigration politics & policy” – *Panelist*

Latin American Political Science Association (LASA)

June 2024

“Affective Journeys: irregularized migrants and socioeconomic
interactions with border towns prior to the Darién Gap” – *Panelist*

Latin American Studies Network of Montreal (RELAM)

May 2022

“Clientelism in Chávez’s Venezuela: The Client’s Perspective” – *Panelist*

Fourth Space Concordia University

Sept. 2021

“Migration and Financial Inclusion: Tracking Migrant Remittances
in North America” – *Presenter*

RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

FIELD WORK

Border towns of Tulcán in Ecuador and Ipiales in
Colombia (*Two weeks*)

June 2024

Border towns of Acandí and Necoclí in Colombia (*One month*)

August 2023

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS York University

Regimes of Closure and Mobility Aspiration
Qualitative research

May 2025 - Present

University of Toronto

Bridging Divides Team Researcher with Dr. Phil Triadafilopoulos <i>Mixed methods research / Migration and Canadian politics</i>	May 2025 - Present
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Assistant of research for Dr. Martha Balaguera: <i>Mixed methods research - irregularised and trans migrations in Central America</i>	2024 - 2025
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Université de Montréal	Fall 2022
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Assistant of research for Dr. Ersy Contogouris: <i>Qualitative research - post-colonial and feminist movements in Latin America</i>	
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Concordia University	Sept. 2021- May 2022
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Assistant of research for Dr. Alexandra O. Zeitz: <i>Quantitative research - python models for API data extraction: migrant remittances</i>	
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FELLOWSHIPS

Harney Program Graduate Fellowship - Munk School <i>(Graduate Student Fellow in Ethnic, Immigration, and Pluralism Studies)</i>	2025-2026
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Inclusion and Governance in Latin America (ÉRIGAL) <i>(Undergraduate Student Fellow)</i>	Fall 2021
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AWARDS

SSHRC Canada Graduate Research Scholarships – Doctoral (CGRS D)	2026-2028
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Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS)	2025-2026
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Desjardins Youth Scholarship	Fall 2024
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Concordia Arts and Science Scholar Award Top 1% student in 2021-2022	Fall 2022
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Desjardins Foundation Scholarship for Graduate Studies	Fall 2022
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Desjardins Foundation Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies	Fall 2021
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Concordia Undergraduate Student Research Award (CUSRA)	Summer 2021
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TEACHING

University of Toronto	
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POL305 - Intro to Latin American Politics & Societies <i>Teaching Assistant (TA)</i>	Fall 2025
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POL360 - Topics in Latin American Politics <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2025
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POL377A - Gender and the Politics of Development <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2025
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POL378 - Cities and Citizenship <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2024
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POL377B - Violence, Development, and Difference <i>Teaching Assistant (TA)</i>	Fall 2024
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JPR374 - Religion and Power in the Postcolony <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2024
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POL219 - Institutions and Behavior in Comparative Perspective <i>(TA)</i>	Winter 2024
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McGill University	
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MATH 249 Honours Complex Variables <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2020
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MATH 248 - Honours Advanced Calculus <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2019
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MATH 458 - Honours Differential Geometry <i>(grader)</i>	Winter 2018
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MATH 235 - Algebra I <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2018; Fall 2019
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LANGUAGES

French (C2) - Spanish (C2) - English (C2) - Portuguese (B1)

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Office, Python, Java, R, SQL, LaTeX, Google API, Stata
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NON ACADEMIC WORK

Caisse de Dépôt et placement du Quebec

Summer 2019; Jan-June 2020

Intern: programmer of economic models on Python and SQL